

The Balochistan University of Information Technology, Engineering & Management Sciences (BUITEMS) emphasizes quality and excellence in education as its core value statement. According to the Undergraduate Prospectus 2024 for the Faculty of Information and Communication Technology, the institution is a global hub for SDG8 under the United Nations Academic Impact for the periods of 2018, 2021, and 2024. BUITEMS is ranked number four by the Higher Education Commission for Computer Science and Information Technology and is a member of six reputed international networks and associations. The university boasts an 80% job placement ratio within the first year of graduation and hosts over 100 open days and events annually. Dr. Khalid Hafeez, the Vice Chancellor and a professor of AI and Digital Transformation with numerous international fellowships and certifications, welcomes students to an environment supported by excellent research faculty and infrastructure. The university aims to produce knowledge with local, regional, and global relevance while mixing learning with real-world experience and a future of work outlook. Laboratories are equipped with the latest technologies for industry, and academic faculty offer research, consulting, and short courses. Classroom teaching is informed by global practices and supported by guest lectures, workshops, training, and employability skills. Graduates are intended to possess a global vision to provide solutions for business, social, and industry problems. The university provides national-level sports facilities, high-quality accommodation, transport services, and is located near Quetta Airport.

BUITEMS provides transformative education through a wide range of academic programs across engineering, sciences, and arts, offering multidisciplinary learning opportunities across five faculties. The university's quest for academic excellence is based on the students, faculty, curriculum, learning environment, and the civil society it serves. The Faculty of Information and Communication Technology (FICT) comprises seven departments: Computer Science, Information Technology, Computer Engineering, Electronic Engineering, Electrical Engineering, Software Engineering, and Telecommunication Engineering. These faculties and departments are responsible for determining the curriculum, organizing academic activities, setting examinations, and maintaining an environment conducive to innovation. The university seeks individuals with strong academic ability, potential, and a genuine interest in their chosen fields who can grow within the BUITEMS environment. Students are advised to choose fields they are excited about and to aim for excellent cumulative grade point averages (CGPA) through independent study and following instruction. Self-motivated students who can think critically and work independently are highly encouraged to apply.

Applying to BUITEMS involves choosing a major, filling out an admission form via the online system or at the campus office, and paying the processing fee. Merit is calculated based on 17% matriculation marks, 50% intermediate marks, and 33% NTS admission test scores. Eligible students are invited to take the NTS test for their specific major, and admission offers are based on the resulting merit. Diversity is encouraged, and international students are invited to apply with the same eligibility requirements as local applicants. Transfer students must secure marks equal to or higher than the minimum merit of their desired program. BUITEMS has a student body of over 8,000 and faculty from leading institutions. Required supporting documents for application include attested copies of secondary and higher secondary certificates, CNIC or B-form, local or domicile documents, bank receipts for fees, six photographs, father's or guardian's CNIC, and a character certificate. The online application fee is Rs. 4000 for national applicants.

and US \$55 for foreign applicants, while manual processing is Rs. 3500. Documents should be sent to the Admissions Office at the Takatu Campus in Quetta. Only candidates with complete applications will be notified and issued an admit card for the mandatory admission test.

The duration of BS programs is four years over eight semesters, while the B. Arch program is five years over ten semesters, with each semester lasting 18 weeks. MS programs typically take two years. While changing programs is discouraged, it may be allowed within the first two weeks of the first semester if merit and seat availability criteria are met. Students falling below a 2.0 CGPA are placed on probation; failure to raise the CGPA after three probations results in being dropped from the university rolls. A minimum CGPA of 2.0 is required for undergraduate graduation and 2.5 for MS graduation. Students may freeze at most two semesters after their first semester. The standard course load is 15-18 credit hours, though up to 21 may be allowed with approval. Financial assistance options include merit scholarships, work-study programs, fee concessions for needy students, siblings, or dependents of employees, and USAID need-based scholarships.

Academic excellence at FICT is highlighted by the annual funding of 10 innovative research projects by the Ministry of Information Technology and a 14:1 student-to-teacher ratio. The Graduate Studies Office assists in the systematic completion of MS and PhD programs designed to meet global trends and HEC requirements. Teaching methods include lectures lasting one to three hours, three-hour laboratory experiments, supervisions for in-depth discussion, and study tours to industries. Undergraduate students complete a year-long final year project, while graduate students produce a thesis. Peer mentoring and internships, with over 400 FICT students placed annually, provide practical support and workplace experience. Facilities include libraries with over 40,000 books, digital access to IEEE, Springer, ACM, and ScienceDirect, as well as specialized research centers and senior design labs. Art galleries on campus showcase modern art created by students and faculty.

During the COVID-19 pandemic, BUIITEMS transitioned to 100% online readiness through an agreement with Microsoft for Office 365 and Teams accounts. The university recognizes that online teaching will remain a part of future practices. Student life includes over 20 clubs and societies, world-class sports facilities, and non-stop events like the Spring Festival and Culture Fest. The annual Olympiad involves over 1,000 athletes in 15 sports categories. Community service is a core aspect, with the Free Citizen Schools educating child laborers and regular blood donation drives. Sports facilities feature a multi-purpose complex, a PCB-standard cricket stadium, and a lush green football ground.

Quetta, known as the fruit basket of Pakistan, offers a unique environment with mountains, lakes, and fruit orchards. BUIITEMS facilitates campus tours for school children and provides various dining options like Road Stoves and Usmania Café. The campus is located 3 km from Quetta International Airport and adjacent to the RCD International Highway. Nearby attractions include Hanna Lake, Hazarganji Chiltan National Park, Pir Ghaib, and various museums. BUIITEMS serves as a global SDG8 hub, ensuring capstone projects contribute to sustainable goals and hosting events like the Quetta Literary Festival and the ICE Cube international conference. Notable student achievements include participation in BAIMUN, success in the Huawei Seeds

for the Future Program, and winning a top 10 global position in the Google Android Developers Challenge with the AgriFarm app.

Research and development are central to BUIITEMS, managed through the Office of Research, Innovation, and Commercialization (ORIC). Highlighted funded projects include studies on online education, groundwater management in Balochistan, and bio-telemetry antenna systems. Specialized labs include the Control, Automotive & Robotics Lab (CARL), which develops robot-assisted systems such as search and rescue snake robots and autonomous campus buses, and the Spatial Decision Support System Lab (SDSS), focusing on GIS applications for forensics, health, and mineral mapping.

FICT degree programs in Computer Science, Electrical Engineering, Computer Engineering, Software Engineering, Electronic Engineering, and Information Technology are designed for the fast-paced technology industry. Computer Engineering focuses on both hardware and software for industrial automation and robotics, offering BS and MS degrees accredited by PEC. Computer Science, one of the pioneer departments, offers BS, MS, and PhD programs accredited by NCEAC. Electrical Engineering emphasizes power systems and communication, offering programs from BS to PhD. Electronic Engineering prepares graduates for roles in telecom and manufacturing, with BS and MS programs. Information Technology focuses on systems analysis and IT infrastructure management, ranked highly by HEC. Software Engineering employs a "learning by doing" pedagogy for the design and maintenance of complex software systems.

FICT's interdisciplinary faculty includes professors like Bakhtiar Khan Kasi, Zahid Rauf, and Surat Khan, with research interests ranging from machine learning to renewable energy. Student support services include class counselors, departmental focal persons, the Chairperson's office, faculty coordinators, and the Dean's office. Specific support is provided for international students and students with disabilities. Career services provide counseling, job placement assistance, and internships. Quetta is accessible by road from major cities like Karachi (686 km), Lahore (935 km), and Islamabad (911 km), as well as by air and rail.